

Sterna dougallii dougallii

sterna tern

Family (Laridae)

Kingdom (Animalia)

Status (Endangered and
Threatened)

Description

A seabird measuring approximately 40 cm, with light gray wings and back and a white body. It has a black cap and, during the breeding season, a pinkish hue on its chest and belly. Its tail is deeply forked, with long feathers that stick out when it lands. During the breeding season, the base of its beak and its legs turn a reddish-orange color.



Location/Habitat

The *Sterna dougallii dougallii* (roseate tern) is found across the Caribbean, including Puerto Rico, the Virgin Islands, and other tropical coastal regions. It nests on small, sparsely vegetated rocky offshore islands, often using crevices, ledges, or open ground near the sea.

Sources: <https://ecos.fws.gov/ecp/species/2083>

https://www.itis.gov/servlet/SingleRpt/SingleRpt?search_topic=TSN&search_value=176892#null